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Culture (OWC): [Suku \(FO46\)](#)

Region: Africa

Sub Region: Central Africa

Field Date: 1958-1959

Coverage Date: 1920 AD - 1960 AD

Place Coverage

Kwango district, Bandundu, Democratic Republic of the Congo

Section Title(S)

The Truncated Patrilineage and the Residential Group

The *kitaata* excludes the father's father but includes his patrilineal descendants down to Ego's own generation. Thus, it embraces the following persons: Ego's father and the latter's siblings by the same father (and regardless of mother); and all the children of males of the previous group. Ego's father's brother is a senior member of this group but he is also a junior member of an older *kitaata* from which Ego is excluded. Analytically, these relationships give rise to a group based on the members of the lower generation and including persons of the generation above; the upper generation of this group is, in turn, the base of another such two-generational group. This organization is summarized in [Cross-Reference: \(Diagram I\)](#). (page 108).

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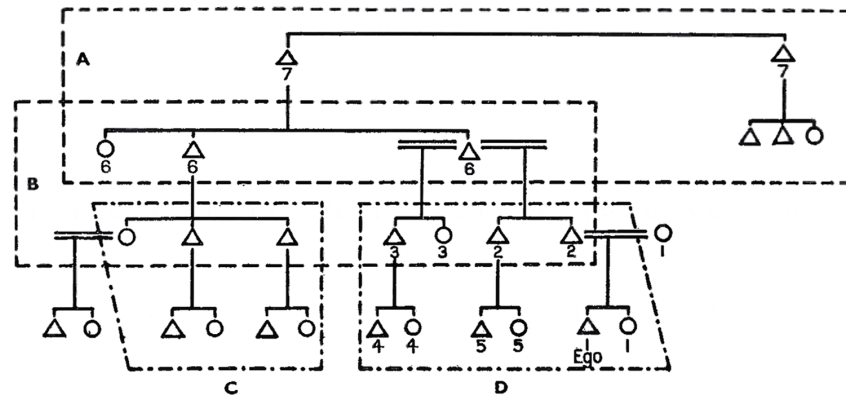
DIAGRAM I.

A, B, C and D represent truncated *kitaata* patrilineages. A polygynous marriage has been introduced to emphasize the strictly patrilineal nature of the *kitaata* relationship. Thus, Ego's *kitaata* D includes his father's half-siblings whose matrilineage is different from that of Ego's father. Numbers are used to indicate common membership in a matrilineage; for example, Ego, his sister, and their mother are all marked 1.

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We have here a proliferating series of two-generational, interlocking patrilineal groups, B being one of at least two possible *kitaata* groups springing from A, and B in turn giving rise to C and D. Each group, by definition, excludes its common progenitor in the generation above it although it is from him that its patrilineal unity is derived; for this reason, we have referred to the *kitaata* group as a truncated patrilineage. The entire structure is not a lineage of a larger order for it is given no cultural recognition; the patrilineal relationship does not extend beyond the boundaries of a person's *kitaata*. Thus, the relationship between Ego and his grandfather is a joking one (as it is with any true or classificatory grandparent), but in this case it is entirely devoid of any economic, legal, or ritual functions, this grandfather being a member neither of Ego's matrilineage nor of his *kitaata*. Similarly, a person in the *kitaata* group C, although classified terminologically as Ego's 'father' or 'sibling', does not have with Ego a relationship involving any of the legal elements that are present when one is dealing [108Cross-Reference: \(DIAGRAM I was originally published in this location\)](#) with similar relatives who belong to the same matrilineage or the same *kitaata* group.

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